

Anatomic Directions

Directional Term	Description	Example
Superior (cranial)	Toward the head	The superior fibers of the trapezius muscle are often referred to as the upper traps.
Inferior (caudal)	Away from the head	The inferior angle of the scapula is where the lat attaches to the scapula.
Proximal	Toward the center of the body	The proximal attachments of the biceps brachii are on the coracoid process and supraglenoid tubercle of the scapula.
Distal	Away from the center of the body	The distal attachment of the biceps brachii is on the radial tuberosity.
Anterior	Front	During an overhead squat assessment, it is important to look at the feet and knees from an anterior view.
Posterior	Back	A posterior view during an overhead squat assessment allows the Sports Performance Coach to look for a hip shift.
Medial	Toward the midline	The medial collateral ligament is at risk during loaded knee valgus, which includes resistance training, landing, and run deceleration.
Lateral	Away from the midline	A lateral shuffle is when an athlete's body faces forward but shuffles sideways.
Superficial	Shallow, just under the skin	Subcutaneous fat is superficial fat just under the skin.
Deep	Away from the skin, farther inside the body	Visceral fat is deep fat found around organs.
Ipsilateral	Same side	When climbing a ladder, the ipsilateral arm and leg reach up at the same time.
Contralateral	Opposite side	When running, the contralateral arm and leg move into flexion and extension.
Unilateral	On one side of the body	A unilateral dumbbell chest press increases core engagement to help stabilize the LPHC.
Bilateral	On both sides of the body	A back squat is a bilateral leg exercise designed to increase strength of the major muscle groups of the lower body in body legs concurrently.